

The motion is **granted**. Counsel is directed to serve the order relieving counsel in compliance with CRC 3.1362(d). **Counsel is not formally relieved until the order is served on the client and proof of service is filed with the court.**

3. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C23-03009
CASE NAME: RONALD ABBS, JR. VS. DAVID BOLES
***HEARING ON MOTION FOR DISCOVERY COMPEL FURTHER RESPONSES TO FORM INTERROGATORIES**
FILED BY: S&J PROPERTIES, CONSTRUCTION, INC.
TENTATIVE RULING:

Withdrawn by moving party December 4, 2025.

4. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-00492
CASE NAME: THELMA JACKSON VS. JOHN PAULDING
***HEARING ON MOTION IN RE: CONFIRM REFEREE REPORT AND TO ALLOCATE SALE PROCEEDS**
FILED BY:
TENTATIVE RULING:

Introduction

Before the Court is Attorney Endy Ukoha-Ajike's motion to impose a lien on this instant partition action on the Paulding Defendants portion of the subject property.

For the following reasons, **Attorney Endy Ukoha-Ajike's motion is granted.**

Factual and Procedural Background

Clients came to an attorney requesting assistance in a title dispute and associated unlawful detainer matter. They signed an agreement granting the attorney a lien on the subject property in exchange for legal services. At the time this legal agreement was signed, John Paulding and Timothy Paulding were residing in real property located at 5648 Burlingame Ave., Richmond, California. This property had belonged to their mother, Shirley Hart and her sister, Thelma Jackson, in joint tenancy.

Shirley Hart had formed a revocable trust and recorded a deed from herself to the Trust. After, she died on August 8, 2021, Thelma Jackson filed an Affidavit of Death of Joint Tenant claiming that the property belonged to her in its entirety. She then sent a letter demanding that John Paulding and Timothy Paulding vacate and hand over possession of the property to her. Subsequently she filed an unlawful detainer action to evict them from the property based on her claim that the property belonged to her.

Attorney Endy Ukoha-Ajike on behalf of John and Timothy Paulding then filed a petition under Probate Code §850 to establish that at least 50% of the property belonged to the Shirley Hart Trust whose Trustee and equal beneficiaries were John and Timothy Paulding. Attorney Endy Ukoha-Ajike on their behalf also mounted a defense to the unlawful detainer action filed by Ms. Jackson. Following a trial on November 3, 2023, Department 15 of this court ruled in their favor on the §850 petition and movant successfully obtained a 50% interest in the Burlingame Avenue property for the Pauldings. Attorney Endy Ukoha-Ajike defeated the unlawful detainer action subsequently. The representation